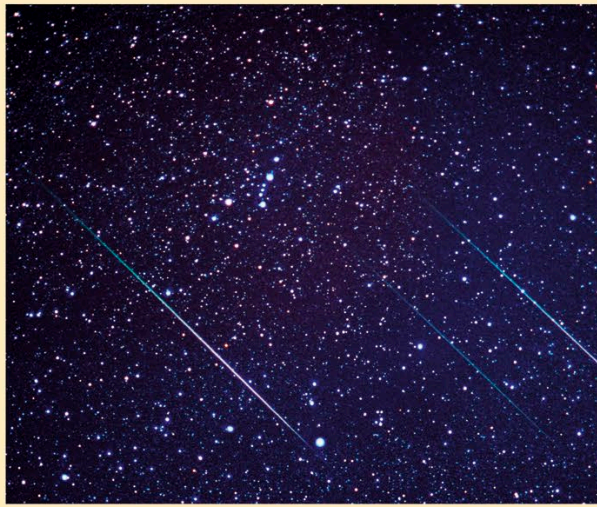


For six days, fragments of comet hit Jupiter.



Meteor shower

When pieces of comet burn up in the Earth's atmosphere, they produce meteor showers – bright shooting stars that race across the night sky, as in this picture of Leonid meteors.

Spot the difference

Here's a guide to space objects you'll find in this section.



Meteors, or “shooting stars”, are short-lived streaks of light produced by space dust speeding through the Earth's atmosphere.



Asteroids are basically giant boulders of rock, some so big that they have their own tiny moons.



Meteorites are bits of space rock that survive the journey through the Earth's atmosphere and hit the Earth.



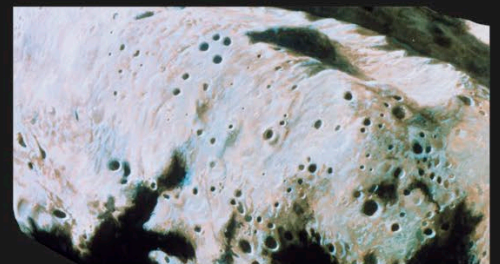
Comets are space snowballs, made from dust and ice, that orbit the Sun.



Space junk is made of man-made things that have been left or lost in space.

Picture detective

Look through the Comets and Meteors section and see if you can identify the pictures below.



Turn and learn

Asteroids:
pp. 82-83

Space debris:
pp. 86-87

